

2 THE GRAPEVINE

A black and white photograph of a large crowd of people, likely at a protest or rally. The image is overlaid with large, bold red text and several red starburst graphics. The word 'TOGETHER' is the most prominent text, spanning across the middle of the image. The crowd is seen from behind, looking towards a building in the background. The overall tone is one of solidarity and collective action.

TOGETHER

WHO ARE WE
WITHOUT EACH
OTHER?

ISSUE 2

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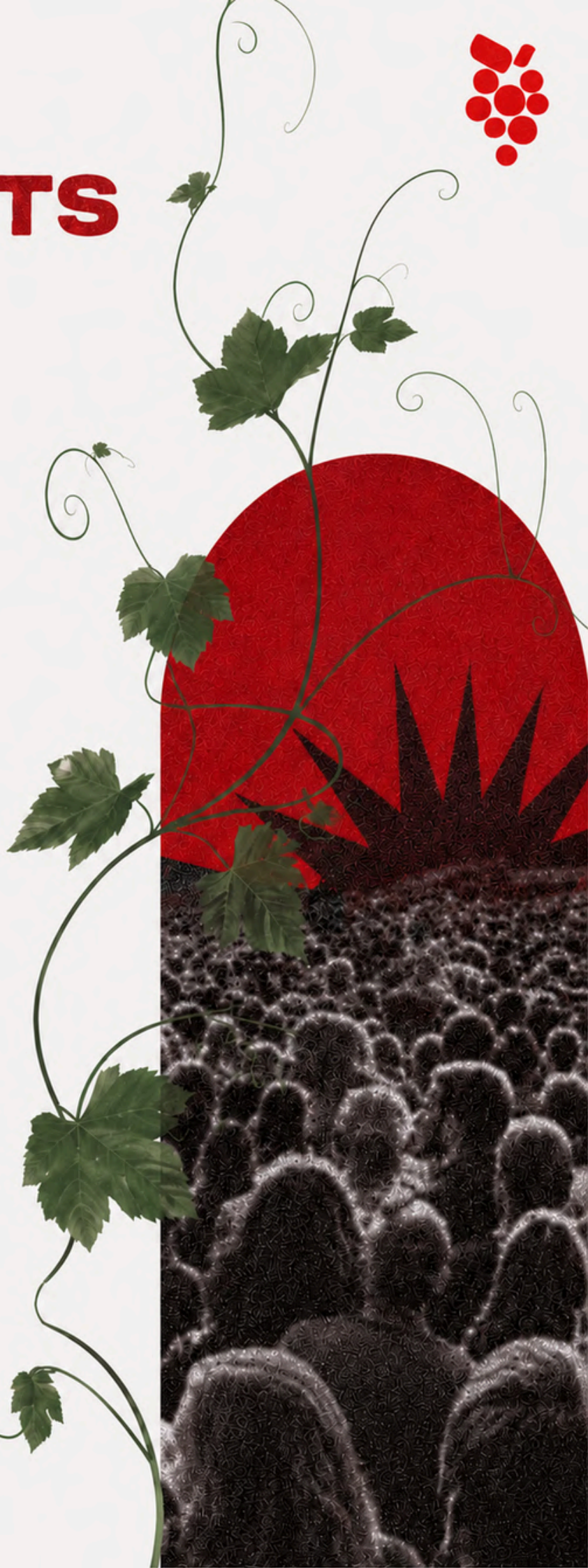
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Thank you!





Welcome

Hello!

Welcome back to the second issue of the Grapevine! We hope you thoroughly enjoyed reading the first one; we have had plenty of submissions for the puzzles and are always looking to expand our team. For this edition, we have plenty of content for you to discover, as well as news from across CRGS! This journal is aimed at lower school students (years 7–11), and we are looking for fresh faces from those years (especially year 9) to join the Grapevine team – we would be very happy to have more journalists, designers and team leaders, especially in lower year groups so that no one is left out from sharing their voice at school. No matter your talent, we can assure you that there is a role for you at the Grapevine!

If you are interested in taking part, or have any other feedback, please email us to get in touch: [click here](#). Furthermore, even if you are not an official member of the team, you can email us with an article you have written on a subject of your choosing – we will review it and, if we think it fits in well with the Grapevine, we can publish it! We'd love to hear from you on how we can improve the Grapevine, as we would like to represent as many people from the lower school as possible to best benefit the CRGS community.

Throughout this issue, you'll hear about some fantastic ways pupils at CRGS have worked together to achieve amazing accomplishments, in competitions and sporting events. As we look to grow our team for the Lower School Journal, our leadership is faced with the task of making sure everyone cooperates with each other, so that we can create this wonderful journal!



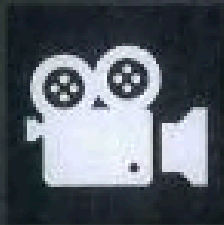
Welcome

From running bake sales to conducting interviews, each element of the Grapevine has to be carefully managed so that it can run smoothly, and we can meet our targets. As you progress through the school system, you will find that day to day life increasingly involves teamwork: whether that be playing in a music ensemble, giving a group presentation in class, or participating in sports events. The ability to communicate your thoughts and ideas with others is vital, not just at school, but in the wider world to coordinate and express yourself to those around you. Many jobs and careers require you to collaborate in a group: this could be pitching an idea for a new product at a business; working with other medical professionals in a hospital; or talking to clients as a lawyer. This makes teamwork an essential skill to have for all walks of life. We hope that this edition of the Grapevine will inspire you to work better with others, no matter what situation you are in!

Just like last time, we hope you will enjoy reading this edition of the Grapevine as much as we have making it! **Happy reading!**

– The Grapevine Editorial Team





FILM SOC



MONDAY EN1 12:50

"★★★★★
for Film Society"
- Giacomo Swift

"Come to Film Society!"
- Amal Patel

RUN BY · VINCENT DYLEWSKI · BARNABY ALEXANDER · TED SLEIGH · SANJIT RAMANAND
HONOURING · OLIVER CRICK AND FILM CLUB · THE ENGLISH DEPARTMENT FOR
LENDING US THE ROOM

STARTING MONDAY 23th MARCH
ALL YEARS WELCOME DEPENDING ON THE
FILM

Life As A CRGS Student (#2)

Introduction

Hello! Welcome back to my series, Life As A CRGS Student! You are now reading the 2nd Issue. If you don't know me or forgot, my name is Taheem! I, obviously, go to CRGS and am in Year 7 (fresh out of primary, although not that fresh anymore...)! I'm the kind of person, who can spend hours, and I mean hours buried inside the Harry Potter series, but I'll drop everything to embrace my computing skills.

The second term at CRGS has been incredibly thrilling, but at the same time immensely overwhelming. Well, the second term at CRGS felt completely different from the first – still busy, still demanding, but in a way that feels far more manageable. After the disorder of the Autumn Term, you start to find your rhythm. The corridors feel less daunting and more... settled. The homework feels less intimidating, and you then realise you are no longer the "new kid," and just "the kid trying to keep up." Instead, your integrated into school life, joining many clubs and societies and your just in the flow of school life! Of course, spring isn't that easy, it still brings many new challenges. Even though this was a short term, there were WAY more assessments and new topics and I was constantly in the race to stay organised, but it also brings a sense of confidence. You begin to realise how CRGS works, how you work and how to balance everything, you know? It's like the term where everything starts to click and the term where you feel you belong at CRGS.

A Midsummer Night's Dream

It wasn't called A Midsummer Night's Dream but rather: Bottom. If you don't know what I'm talking about, I'm referring to our Year 7 Play, based on Shakespeare!



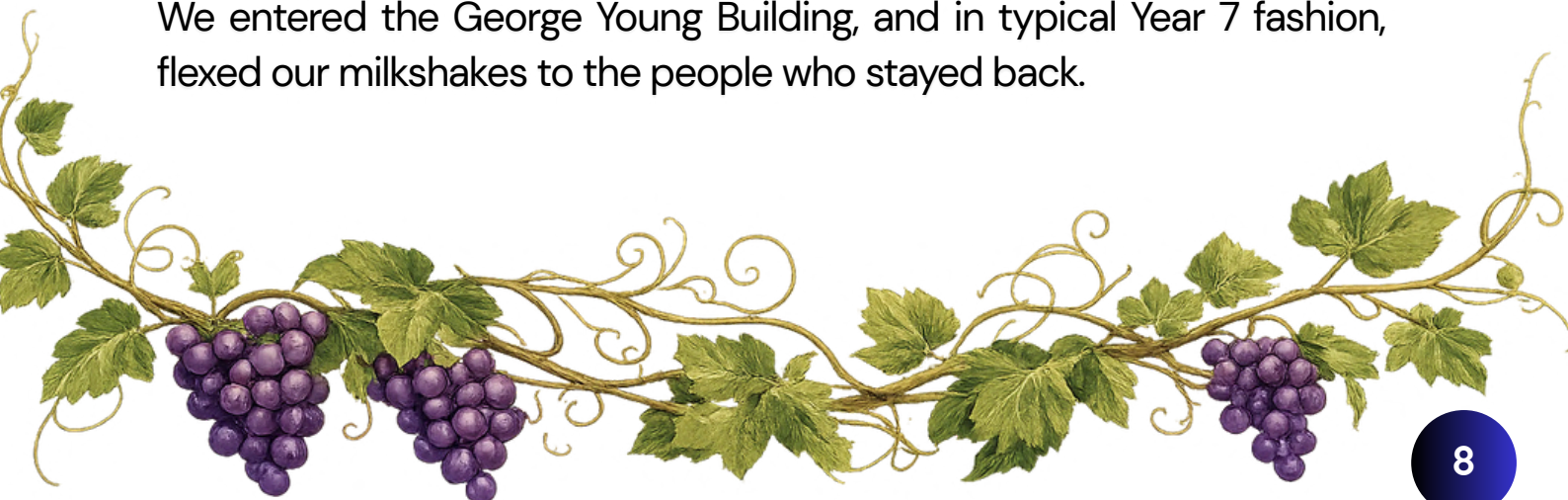


“Just do it.”

It was truly phenomenal! Let me give you a full walkthrough of what happened on that day – it was the ordinary school day and I was in English, where you could feel the excitement buzzing in the air. It was my last lesson before the end of school and we had just finished our assessment (huge relief). As I left the school, I headed out towards town with some of my friends to go and have some food as we would have to come back to school anyways. After 10 – 15 minutes of walking, we had finally reached to our destination! Me and my friends ordered a variety of things, such as chips, wings and other things. We sat ourselves down and waited for our order, which arrived in about 2 minutes. And, oh my god, it was good! Especially for the price, which was incredibly cheap. Anyways, after about 15 minutes, we said “thank you!” to the guy at the counter, left the restaurant and entered back into the High Street.

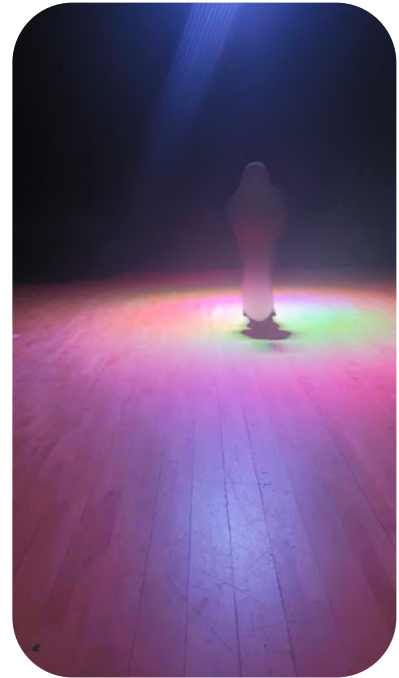
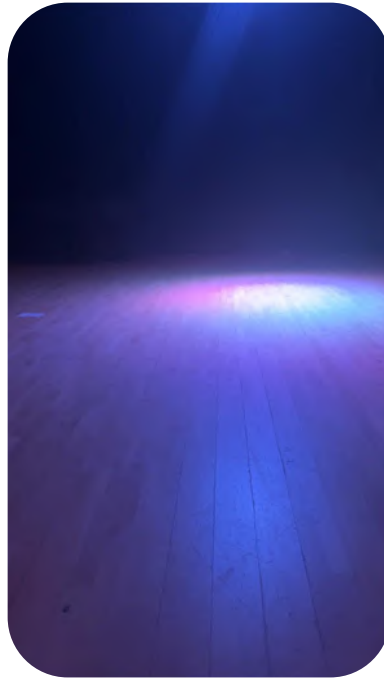
We had to come back to school by about 5:30PM and it was 4:30, so we had some time to burn. So as a group, we decided to go to this heavenly shop called: Tub & Cone. I very much recommend you to go there! We all ordered the Ferrero Milkshake and trust me, it was the BEST milkshake, I’ve had in my whole life. As soon as we had received our milkshakes, we again, said “thank you!” to the cashier and left, immediately heading back to school.

We entered the George Young Building, and in typical Year 7 fashion, flexed our milkshakes to the people who stayed back.



Life As A CRGS Student (#2)

Inside the classroom, was a sensational vibe. Here's some images:



Performing in Bottom was genuinely one of the most exciting experiences I've had in school so far. The whole process – from learning the lines to stepping onto the stage – felt electric. There was this mix of nerves and adrenaline that made every rehearsal feel alive, and by the time we performed, it all came together in a way that felt magical! I'm forever grateful in being a part of such a great, lively and imaginative play and it's something I'll remember for a long time.





“Stay hungry, stay foolish”

Release of the 1st Issue

I don't know if you remember but an email was sent out a couple of weeks ago, including the first release of our prestigious journal! Well, so far, it has been a huge success, so I highly advise you to read it. It has 1.8k views so far (as of March).



Looking Ahead

Anyways, if this term has taught me anything, it's that once you settle into CRGS, everything becomes far less overwhelming. The pace is still fast, but now that I've found my rhythm, it feels manageable rather than chaotic. One of the best parts of this term was performing in A Midsummer Night's Dream — a genuinely exciting experience that pushed me out of my comfort zone and showed me how many opportunities the school offers. Things aren't suddenly easy, but I finally feel confident, settled, and like I truly belong here.

Until then, have a nice holiday and goodbye (ps: this is being published after the holidays but still)!





Book Review Competition

Lucas Lachasseigne

Everyone agrees that reading is awesome! Whether it be sci-fi, fantasy, non-fiction, or anywhere in between, books help to open up your mind to new perspectives on the world. In the period we live in, information is everything, and being able to access literature and texts of any kind is really important. That's why we are so proud of our extensive library at CRGS! And did you know, there is an even better way to see which books we have in stock? If you haven't already, check out Reading Cloud, which can tell you what books are available to borrow and how many loans you have taken out. Simply go to reading-cloud.com, click login, search for Colchester Royal Grammar School, and use your school email and password to continue! You can find the book of the week, featured authors, and star reviews!

Speaking of reviews, did you know there is an ongoing book review competition? To write a review, search up the book you want in Reading Cloud, scroll down to the bottom of the page, and click "Write a Review"! You should try to deliver your opinion on the book clearly in a couple short paragraphs, as well as giving a slight overview of what the book is about (no spoilers of course!). If you are stuck as to what to write, just tell us about what you liked most about the book – did the vivid descriptions appeal to you? Did the writer introduce you to a new topic? Did the author make you laugh with a great joke? This will really help other readers to find books they want to read – so what are you waiting for? Get reviewing!

P.S. Reviews will be judged by the school librarian, Mrs Marsh, and the Student Librarian Team, and the person who writes the best review may even get a library-related prize...



Voices

THE ST MARY'S DEBATE



All images used to accompany this article were taken outside of school time with prior consent from all parties involved.

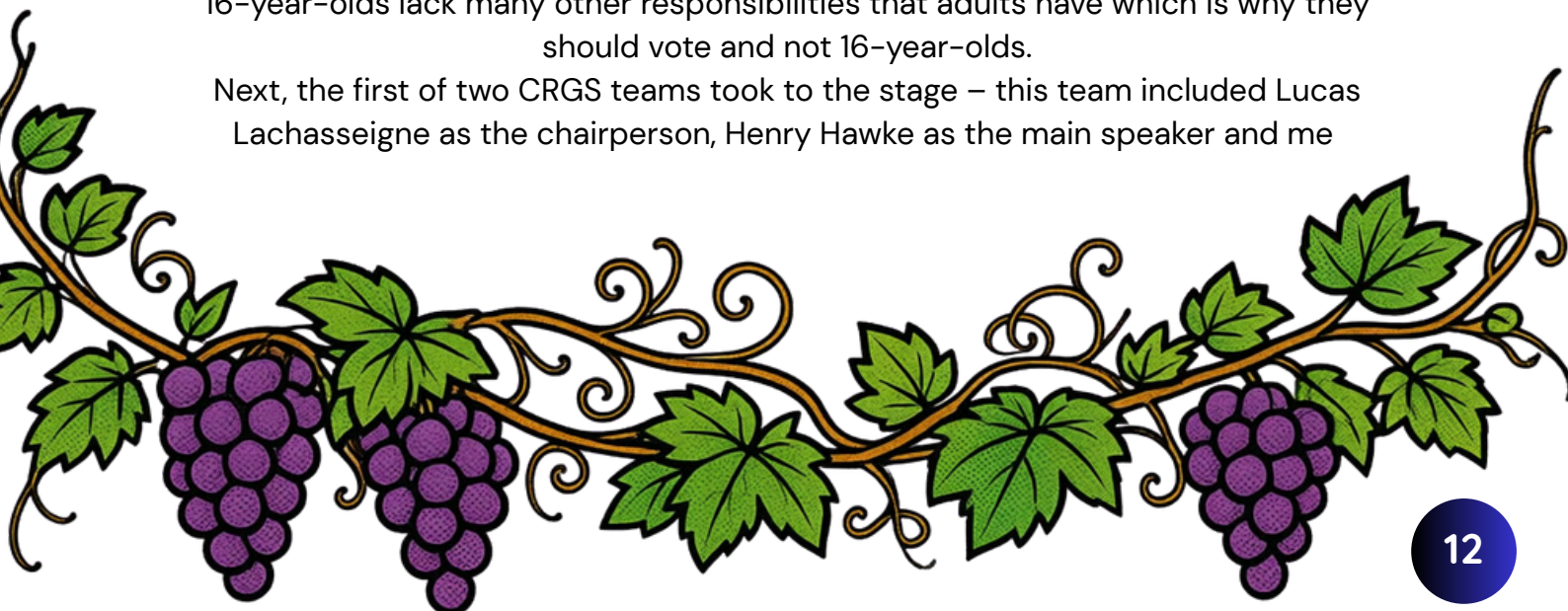
On Wednesday the 4th of March, CRGS took two teams of three speakers each to the St Mary's Debate Competition.

As we left school, led by Mr Jasper, we were buzzing with nervous excitement about what was to come. None of us had done anything like this before and so we had no prior expectations of what lay ahead of us. On entering the St Mary's site, we were greeted by a virtual turret and an array of beautiful school buildings. We arrived at the reception area and

were kindly showed towards a waiting area which contained some truly exceptional cookies (CRGS take note)! Later on, after representatives of the other competing schools (namely St. Bens, the Gilberd, CCHSG and the hosts) arrived, we went to their hall and sat down, waiting for the competition to commence.

The competition began with the guest team from St Mary's who weren't actually competing – just showing us an example speech. Their topic was whether we should lower the voting age to 16, and they argued that we should not lower the voting age as 16-year-olds lack many other responsibilities that adults have which is why they should vote and not 16-year-olds.

Next, the first of two CRGS teams took to the stage – this team included Lucas Lachasseigne as the chairperson, Henry Hawke as the main speaker and me



"Question everything."

as the voter of thanks. Our topic was why we should ban social media for under 19s. In our time

on stage, we explored the negative cognitive effects of social media alongside the similarities of social media to addictive drugs such as alcohol and illegal drugs too. I was nervous stepping up onto the stage, however once I started talking, I became much more comfortable.

After our speech, we sat down to listen to speeches from other teams, St Bens talked about how schools don't provide enough

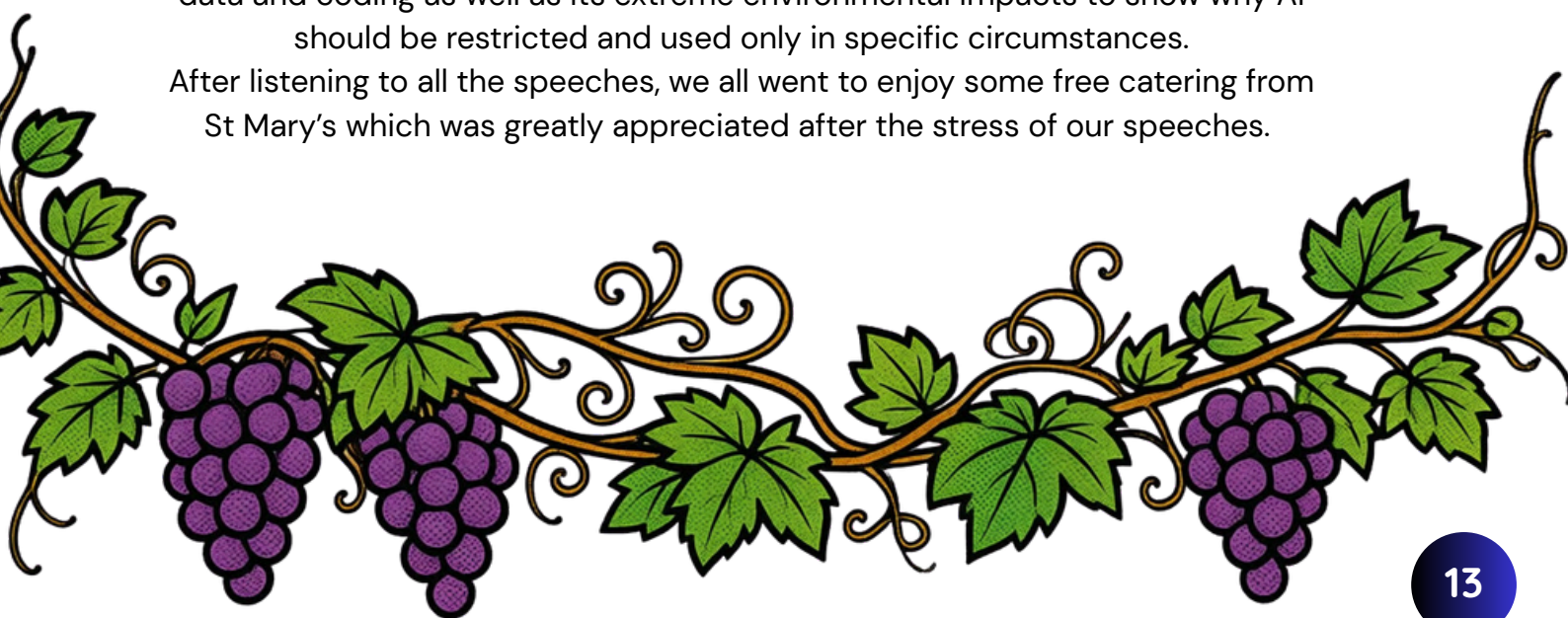
THE ST MARY'S

DEBATE



support for students who are bilingual and speak different languages at home. Their argument was very interesting and a topic I hadn't previously given much thought to. CCHSG discussed the importance of adaptability to change, their main speaker was particularly animated and answered questions from the audience very well. The Gilberd spoke about whether parents are putting too much pressure on their children to go into specific sectors. Our second CRGS team (consisting of Rafael Quader, Aarav Singh and Shriyan Kar) talked about the dangers of AI – they used the examples of its racial biases and incomplete data and coding as well as its extreme environmental impacts to show why AI should be restricted and used only in specific circumstances.

After listening to all the speeches, we all went to enjoy some free catering from St Mary's which was greatly appreciated after the stress of our speeches.



T20 Titans: India Takes The Title



I don't know about you, but I spent my Sunday glued to the TV screen, watching a superb India side crush New Zealand to take home their third T20 World Cup, becoming the most successful team in the history of the competition. Let's look back at this historic win.



India's journey to the final wasn't smooth sailing. In one of their Super Eights matches, South Africa handed India a heavy 76-run defeat, bowling them out for just 111 after posting 187, with David Miller and Dewald Brevis starring in South Africa's innings — a result that shocked many fans and ended India's unbeaten streak in T20 World Cups. That loss shook up India— but they responded in style. In their very next Super Eights game, smashing Zimbabwe by 72 runs by scoring 256-4 and restricting Zimbabwe to 184-6, a performance that kept their semifinal hopes alive and showed that they had no intention of going anywhere.

After the Super Eights, India faced a huge test in the semi-final against England at the Wankhede Stadium. In a thrilling high-scoring clash, India posted a massive 253-7 thanks to powerful hitting at the top of the order, including a dominant innings by Sanju Samson. England fought back strongly, scoring 246-7 – with Jacob Bethell even scoring 105 runs, but India held on and secured a narrow seven-run victory in what was one of the most exciting games of the tournament. They were ready to take on New Zealand and defend their title on home soil.



"History isn't just written; it's earned."



In the final against New Zealand, India put on an incredible all-round performance to win the T20 World Cup in stunning fashion. Batting first at the Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad, India posted a massive 255-5, the highest team total in a men's T20 World Cup final, thanks to an unbelievable 89 from Sanju Samson, a quickfire 52 from Abhishek Sharma and a powerful 54 from Ishan Kishan in a dominant batting display. Shivam Dube also had a strong final over, scoring 24 runs. Their bowlers then took over, with Jasprit Bumrah's magical four-wicket haul –



including 2 wickets in a row!– earning Player of The Match– and strong support from Axar Patel causing New Zealand to score just 159 in 19 overs , with Tilak Varma's catch from Jacob Duffy (the 10th wicket!) sealing a 96-run victory and a historic championship. This win not only made India back-to-back T20 World Cup champions but also the first men's team to win three titles and the first to lift the trophy on home soil. Incredibly, Suryakumar Yadav , despite only making his international T20I debut at 30, captained India at the age of 35 to their third T20 World Cup – an amazing journey.

Sanju Samson also has to be mentioned – his performance throughout the tournament secured him a well-deserved Player of The Tournament. After facing criticism for inconsistent performances earlier in the year and even being left out of matches, Samson proved everybody wrong. Once he got his chance in the World Cup, he proved himself time and time again, ending the tournament with 321 runs in just five innings at an explosive strike rate near 200, making him India's best batter in the tournament.





Samson's journey included three consecutive scores above a half century: a match-winning 97 against the West Indies, a blistering 89 in the semi-final against England, and another 89 in the final against New Zealand, which was the highest individual score in a T20 World Cup final ever.

His performance broke records– surpassing even Virat Kohli's previous Indian record for most runs in a single T20 World Cup edition .

With this third triumph, India have cemented themselves as a dominant force in world cricket – the question is, can anyone stop them?





Ed Urwin

CRGS Sport - Summer Term 26

1st team cricket in 2026:

Recently, the fixtures for the CRGS Cricket 1st XI have been released and are as follows:

Tuesday 21st April vs RHS (A)

Tuesday 28th April vs Forty Club (H)

Tuesday 5th May vs MCC (H)

Tuesday 19th May vs Bishop Stortford (H) - 20/20

Tuesday 9th June vs Gents of Essex (H)

Wednesday 10th June vs St Joseph's (H)

Tuesday 16th June vs Ipswich (H)

Tuesday 23rd June vs Gresham's (H)

Monday 29th June to Friday 3rd July - RGS Festival Worcester

Friday 10th July vs OC's (H)



This packed schedule will hopefully facilitate some incredible cricket in the summer term to back up the school's cricketing success last year, winning their first game at the RGS festival in 7 years.

As well as the senior cricket side being in constant action this summer, our age group sides are looking for big seasons and hopefully some big wins in the summer months. Some extremely talented youngsters are hoping to make an impression this year which will hopefully encourage Mr Elmakelah to select them for the senior side as soon as possible, these include the likes of Imran Chaudhary, Nived Nair, Sarvesh Ilangkumaran and Ollie Schofield who will be tussling for spots when older players are away on exam leave.

Another question which will be answered in this year's cricket season is whether the year 10 team will manage to actually be able to get a win after a painful 2 year drought.

Overall, we should see an enthralling summer of cricket which will be capped off by a longer, 40 over match against the Old Colcestrians to hopefully finish a great season with a bang.

Match Report - CRGS 7-0 TLA

As TLA visited CRGS recently to play against our year 10s, they would've hoped for a far better score line in a true trouncing which showed the talent of our team. A Somto Nwaogu hat-trick alongside Sam Thornton's plentiful assists aided the CRGS side to rip through TLA's defence. When asked in a recent post-match interview, goalkeeper Pete Haines had a lot to say despite not having a huge amount to do all game.

Commenting about his personal performance, Pete said, 'The game was fairly quiet for me as we were in possession and attacking most of the match'. Having not watched the match myself, I was interested in what the best goal CRGS scored was, but in answer to my question, Pete told me, 'There were lots of great goals scored so it's hard to pick out one'. Despite not having any action down his end for most of the game, Haines didn't find himself bored, saying that he was 'in a good position to sit back and watch the match', showing how enjoyable the match was for any CRGS supporters. Pete also told me that CRGS could've scored more despite their seven goals, yet said that the team were still very pleased with their result and are hoping to carry their goalscoring form into some difficult upcoming fixtures.

LUKA GOLUBOVIC

YEAR 9 FRENCH EXCHANGE

B

etween our star-crossed school life, the Year Nines betrayed us! Since, on a simmering Wednesday morning, they snuck out to traverse a foreign city unlike anything with us — life, culture, beauty of cloudless skies (really):

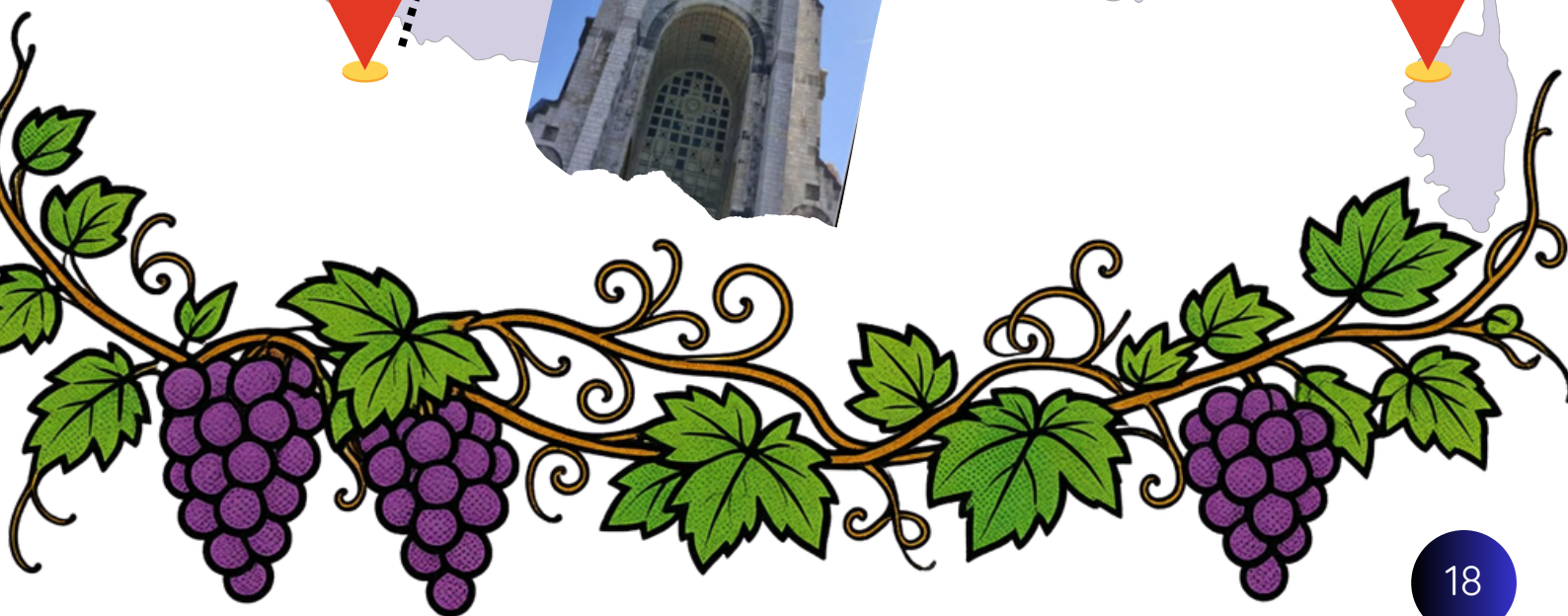
Lyon!

I've never seen the city, but it lights every chamber in me like firecrackers: treks across the senior town, secret escape routes from Germany during World War Two, monumental basilicas (those are ornate Roman halls — see pictures!).

But if that doesn't tempt you, will the Musée de Confluence — a fascinating museum full of artefacts, animals and especially zombies — be your latest love? I think the design is stunning; it symbolises the harmony of nature, living on the convergence of two rivers.

How do you feel about it?

Now, spread your smile to a second city: Annecy, a picturesque place with dazzling architecture — plus a breath-taking cruise, its passengers gawping at some of the most expensive houses in France. The crystalline lake (famously called Lake Annecy) was so clear it was, truly, drinkable.



YEAR 9 FRENCH EXCHANGE

And... of course, it was an exchange!

Each person spent their weekend and final day with their exchange partners, learning languages in their most natural and immersive way. Exposure!

Inevitably, on the final day, the Year Nines visited Saint-Thomas d'Aquin school and discovered just how dreadful the English language is. Honestly. I think the French school culture is fascinating — did you know the timetable changes every single day?

Imagine what CRGS would be like in France...

So, maybe journalling is a comparatively sane response to my friends cruelly bonding through this exchange — but yes, for us Year Eights, the best is yet to come.

(Credits irrefragably for everything [and this article is for you]: Luke S)





PUZZLES

ELLION ANDREWS



Try your hand at these fun riddles! Submit your answer by emailing it to LucasLAC@crgs.co.uk.

On your way to the DIY shop, you count the number of houses on your street. You turn your head left while you're going there and see 10. On your way back you turn your head right and also see 10.

Riddle 1) How many houses did you count?



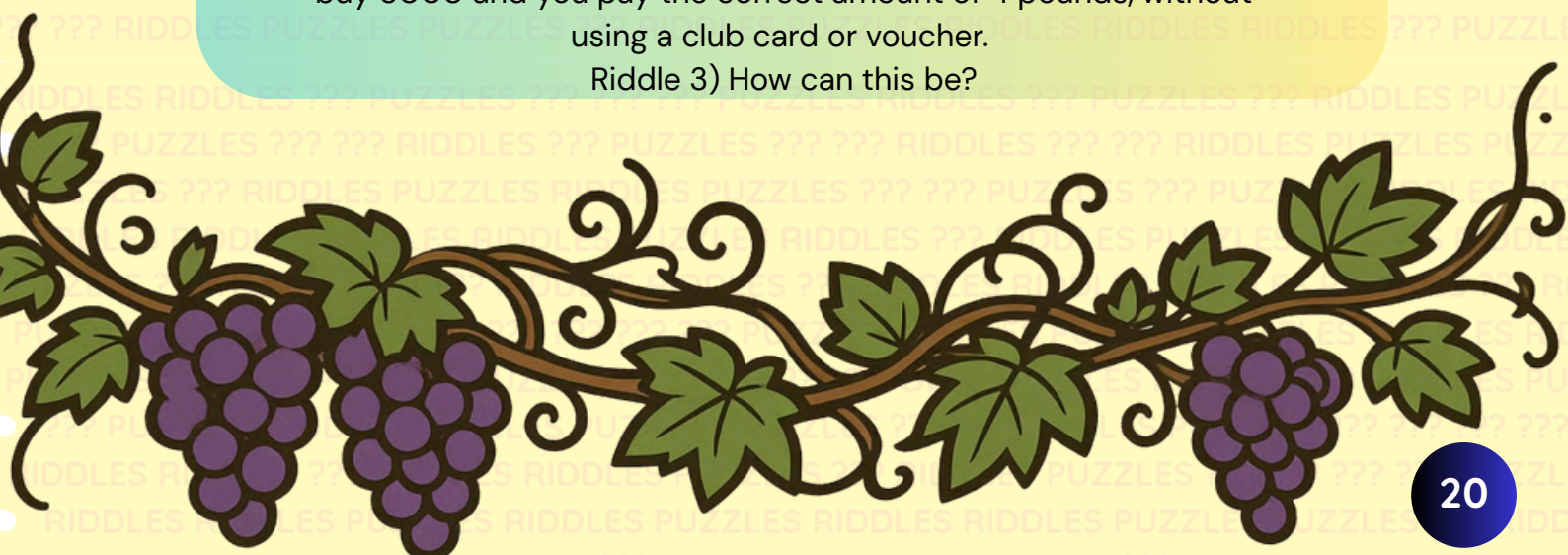
While you are shopping, you buy some beams to make a fence. You need 10 beams to cover one side of your house.

Riddle 2) How many beams do you need to make a full square for your house?



You are told the last thing you need to buy costs 1 pound each. You buy 5000 and you pay the correct amount of 4 pounds, without using a club card or voucher.

Riddle 3) How can this be?



OFF ON A WHIM & THE PHILOSOPHY OF OLIVER CRICK

If someone would have asked me before April 23rd 2026 what my favourite film was, I would have had no idea but after that day(or more specifcally that night) I can say for certain: Off on a Whim. A 185 minute amalgamation of the craziest, funniest and in some ways most beautiful sequence of events that can happen on the last day of school written and directed by Oliver Crick.(a year 13 at CRGS) What began as an idea on a bike ride in June exploded into a full length script written in just 8 days that summer, setting the scene(literally and metaphorically) for the following year and half of production,(Including an intensive half-term with people staying at his house for the whole 9 days!) with the final file size extending beyond 500GB, over 20 spreadsheets being filled out and well over 1000 hours of work culminating in the final film shown to an audience in George Young on the night of April 23rd(With some notable attendees including Sir Mr Richards who was the narrator of the film!). Over the period of production, Oliver's life became the film but perhaps felicitously the film became his life. Some incredibly entertaining, well written and heartfelt events of the film were taken from anecdotes Oliver had heard/experienced throughout his life, fueling the idea of creativity through experience, something clearly evident and proven in the film but perhaps contradicts the view of creativity generally accepted by society which seems to prioritize originality. This ties into the broader philosophical view of the film and Oliver and his friend group of genuinely enjoying life. The premise of going 'off on a whim'(going out spontaneously for no particular reason but to have fun) was something completely foreign to me and my friends watching at the time of viewing but it has completely changed the way that I live. The film zooms in on an idea ~~Your paragraph text~~ this friend group known as 'real life', similar to 'carpe diem' it talks about living ever day to the fullest and genuinely enjoying life, something the characters certainly do whilst 'Off on a Whim'. Realizing that we had perhaps been living wrong this whole time me and my friends wasted no time doing our first 'whim' just 3 days after the film; A 2 hour walk from Colchester to Dedham and have never looked back. Since then we have been on atleast 5 whims enjoying time, (which would have otherwise been spent studying)genuinely living in Real Life. I would like to thank Oliver and the rest of the castfor making this film which had a very real impact and allowing us to come along and wish them all the best luck on their A level's!



Our Team

Yuvan Ananda Arasu

Lucas Lachasseigne

Henry Hawke

Shriyan Kar

Ed Urwin

Tejas Sriram

Leo Hart

Barnaby Alexander

Habeeburrahman Mohammed

Tahmeed Rahman

Taheem Hossainn

Luka Golubovic

Daniel Bennett

Ameen Wahid

Azmayeen Inqiyad

Peter Ntereba

Ted Sleigh

Jake Gooch

Yash Bhardwaj

Vincent Dylewski

Abir Chowdhury

Manas Sriram

Sean Billington

Ellion Andrews

Daniel Ayandare

Alfie Degiorgio

With thanks to Mr Jasper and
the CRGS staff for supporting
the Grapevine.

Could your name be on this
list? Sign up today!



Thank You For Reading Issue Two Of The Grapevine!



Issue 2 has taken a long time to complete, but we hope that you can see every drop of passion that has gone into making it! We would love to expand our team with new designers, writers, and advertisers, so if you are interested please get in touch! Being part of the journal team is a wonderful experience, that helps build essential life skills and shows any jobs or academic institutions you are applying to how well you can cooperate and express yourself. We would highly recommend you sign up if you love writing, creating art or just being part of something bigger!

You can get in touch with the Editors-in-Chief, Lucas Lachasseigne and Henry Hawke, at LucasLAC@crgs.co.uk and HenryHAW@crgs.co.uk . Alternatively, you can come to speak to us or email Mr Jasper.

Again, we hope you have enjoyed reading this edition of the Grapevine, and we hope to see you next time!

P.S: If you are the leader of a club or society and want to put an advertisement into the Grapevine, contact us!

